School of Innovation and Management (SoIM)

Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM)

Course Outline **PGDM (2025-27)** **Trimester** IV

Course Code: 406FS	Fundamentals of Financial Technology (FinTech)	Course Credits: 3

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Course Coverage:

The course introduces the FinTech ecosystem and explains how technology is reshaping banking, payments, lending, investment, regulation and customer experience. It covers the evolution and typology of FinTech, collaboration between financial institutions and start-ups, emerging-market and Indian FinTech developments, digital financial services and payment rails, crowdfunding and peer-to-peer lending, AI/ML and robo-advisory, blockchain and digital assets, and the ethical, cybersecurity and regulatory issues associated with digital finance. The course concludes with emerging trends and a capstone application in which students design and evaluate a FinTech solution.

Course Objectives:

1. Develop a structured understanding of the FinTech ecosystem, its evolution, major segments and business models.
2. Explain digital financial services, payment systems, alternative banking models, crowdfunding and P2P lending.
3. Evaluate the use of AI/ML, robo-advisory, blockchain, crypto-assets and emerging technologies in finance.
4. Assess FinTech risks relating to regulation, compliance, cybersecurity, privacy, consumer protection and ethics.
5. Apply FinTech concepts to analyse real-world business problems and design a viable, responsible digital-finance solution.

Course Learning Outcomes:

CLO 1: Explain the evolution, ecosystem, typology and principal business models of FinTech.
CLO 2: Analyse digital payment systems, digital financial services, new banking models and financial inclusion mechanisms.
CLO 3: Compare crowdfunding, P2P lending and technology-enabled investment/advisory models in terms of value creation and risk.
CLO 4: Evaluate applications of AI/ML, blockchain, crypto-assets and digital identity in financial services.
CLO 5: Examine regulatory, compliance, cybersecurity, privacy, consumer-protection and ethical issues in FinTech.
CLO 6: Design and present a FinTech solution integrating customer need, technology, business model, risk and regulatory considerations.

Assessment Tools for Learning Outcome:

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria
CLO 1 - FinTech foundations, ecosystem, typology and business models	Quiz, class participation and mid-term examination
CLO 2 - Digital financial services, payments, banking models and inclusion	Quiz, case analysis, class participation and mid-term examination
CLO 3 - Crowdfunding, P2P lending and digital investment/advisory	Caselet/group assignment and examinations

CLO 4 - AI/ML, blockchain, digital assets and digital identity	Applied exercise, presentation and end-term examination
CLO 5 - Regulation, cyber risk, privacy, consumer protection and ethics	Case analysis, quiz and end-term examination
CLO 6 - Integrated FinTech solution design	Capstone group project, presentation and peer/faculty evaluation

Pedagogy:

The course will be delivered through interactive lectures, short cases, current industry examples, payment-flow demonstrations, structured debates, problem-based learning and group activities. Students will connect concepts from the prescribed FinTech readings with Indian digital-finance use cases. The 18 contact hours are organised as 12 sessions of 90 minutes each. A capstone exercise will require students to propose a FinTech solution and assess its customer value proposition, technology choice, business model, key risks and regulatory/ethical implications.

Session Plan: 12 sessions of 90 minutes each, totaling 18 Hours.

Session Plan			
S. No.	**Topic**	**Pre-reading / Reference**	**Pedagogy**
1	FinTech Foundations and Evolution • Meaning, scope and transformation of financial services • Evolution from infrastructure and banks to start-ups/platforms • FinTech typology, segments and ecosystem	FinTech Modules: Module 1 The FinTech Book: Ch. 1	Interactive lecture and ecosystem-mapping activity. Students identify how technology changes the value chain in banking, payments, lending and investments.
2	FinTech Ecosystems, India and Business Models • Emerging markets and financial inclusion • India Stack and digital public infrastructure • Account Aggregator and digital identity concepts • Overview of FinTech business models	FinTech Modules: Module 1 The FinTech Book: Ch. 3-4	Discussion using Indian FinTech examples. Small groups map customer problem, enabling infrastructure, revenue logic and ecosystem partners.
3	Digital Financial Services and Payments • DFS and key risks • RTGS, NEFT, UPI, AEPS and QR-code payments • Mobile money and payment innovation	FinTech Modules: Module 2 The FinTech Book: Ch. 5	Payment-flow demonstration and comparison exercise covering speed, access, use case, risk and customer experience.
4	New Banking Models and Bank-FinTech Collaboration • Small finance, payment and universal banking models • Banking-as-a-Service and platform approaches • Collaboration versus competition between banks and FinTechs	FinTech Modules: Modules 1-2 The FinTech Book: Ch. 2 & 7	Case discussion: incumbent bank versus FinTech start-up. Students identify opportunities for collaboration, friction, and strategic benefits.
5	Crowdfunding and Peer-to-Peer Lending • Crowdfunding models • Marketplace/P2P lending • Benefits, risks, trust and disclosure • Regulatory and legal considerations	FinTech Modules: Module 2 The FinTech Book: Ch. 6	Structured caselet comparing alternative funding models. Groups evaluate borrower/investor value, platform risk and regulatory concerns.

6	AI, Machine Learning and Robo-Advisory • ML paradigms and FinTech applications • Credit analytics, prediction and fraud use cases • Robo-advisory and technology-enabled investment	FinTech Modules: Module 3 The FinTech Book: Ch. 5-6	Concept-to-application workshop. Students classify possible AI/ML use cases by data requirement, decision supported, benefit and risk.
	MID-TERM EXAMINATION		
7	Blockchain and Distributed Ledger Technology • Blockchain concept and transaction logic • Benefits and limitations • Types of blockchain • Business applications in financial services	FinTech Modules: Module 3 The FinTech Book: Ch. 9	Blockchain transaction-flow exercise followed by use-case evaluation for payments, settlement, records and financial contracts.
8	Crypto-assets, Digital Assets, NFTs and DeFi • Cryptocurrencies and digital assets • NFTs and tokenisation concepts • DeFi and decentralised finance • Legal and regulatory implications	FinTech Modules: Modules 3 & 5 The FinTech Book: Ch. 9	Debate and risk-mapping exercise distinguishing technology potential, market risk, conduct risk and regulatory issues.
9	RegTech, Compliance, Cybersecurity and Privacy • Regulatory frameworks and compliance • Consumer protection and data privacy • Cybersecurity and fraud prevention • Big data/AI for smart regulation and fraud	FinTech Modules: Module 4 The FinTech Book: Ch. 2 & 5	Case analysis of a digital-finance control failure. Students propose preventive, detective and governance controls.
10	Customer Experience, Digital Identity and Platform Innovation • UX in FinTech • Digital identity and KYC-to-KYD mindset • Data-driven services and platform models • Inclusion and trust	FinTech Modules: Module 5 The FinTech Book: Ch. 2, 4 & 5	Customer-journey mapping activity. Groups redesign one financial-service journey using digital identity/data while considering privacy and inclusion.
11	Emerging Trends and the Future of FinTech • Impact on traditional financial services • AI governance and emerging technology challenges • Future of money, financing, identity and banking • Opportunities and challenges	FinTech Modules: Module 5 The FinTech Book: Ch. 10	Scenario exercise: students evaluate how a selected trend may alter customers, incumbents, FinTech firms and regulators over the next five years.
12	Capstone: Designing a Responsible FinTech Solution • Problem and target customer • Value proposition and business model • Technology and data requirements • Risk, regulation, ethics and implementation roadmap	FinTech Modules: Capstone Project Integrated course readings	Group capstone presentations with peer/faculty evaluation. Each group defends the commercial logic, technology choice, risk controls and regulatory fit.
	END-TERM EXAMINATION		

Recommended Text Book:

Susanne Chishti & Janos Barberis (Eds.), The FinTech Book: The Financial Technology Handbook for Investors, Entrepreneurs and Visionaries, Wiley, 2016.

Reference Text Books/Recourses (Journals, Internet Websites):

1. FinTech Modules (provided course content): Introduction to Financial Technology; Digital Financial Services and Crowdfunding; Technologies in FinTech; Ethical and Regulatory Issues; Opportunities and Innovation.

2. The FinTech Book, selected chapters and cases: Ch. 1 Introduction; Ch. 2 FinTech Themes; Ch. 3 FinTech Hubs; Ch. 4 Emerging Markets and Social Impact; Ch. 5 FinTech Solutions; Ch. 6 Capital and Investment; Ch. 7 Enterprise Innovation; Ch. 9 Crypto-currencies and Blockchains; Ch. 10 The Future of FinTech.
3. Current regulatory/industry notes supplied by the faculty for classroom discussion where required.

Course Evaluation:

Evaluation is a continuous process at SoIM. Students will be given individual/group projects, case analyses, quizzes and a capstone assignment in FinTech. Keeping in line with continuous evaluation at SoIM, the evaluation scheme is as follows:

Areas	Weightage
(I) Continuous Evaluation: *(Quizzes: 10 Marks, Assignments, Group/Individual Projects: 30 Marks*	40%
(II) Mid Term Examination	20%
(III) Final Examination	40%
Total	**100 %**

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